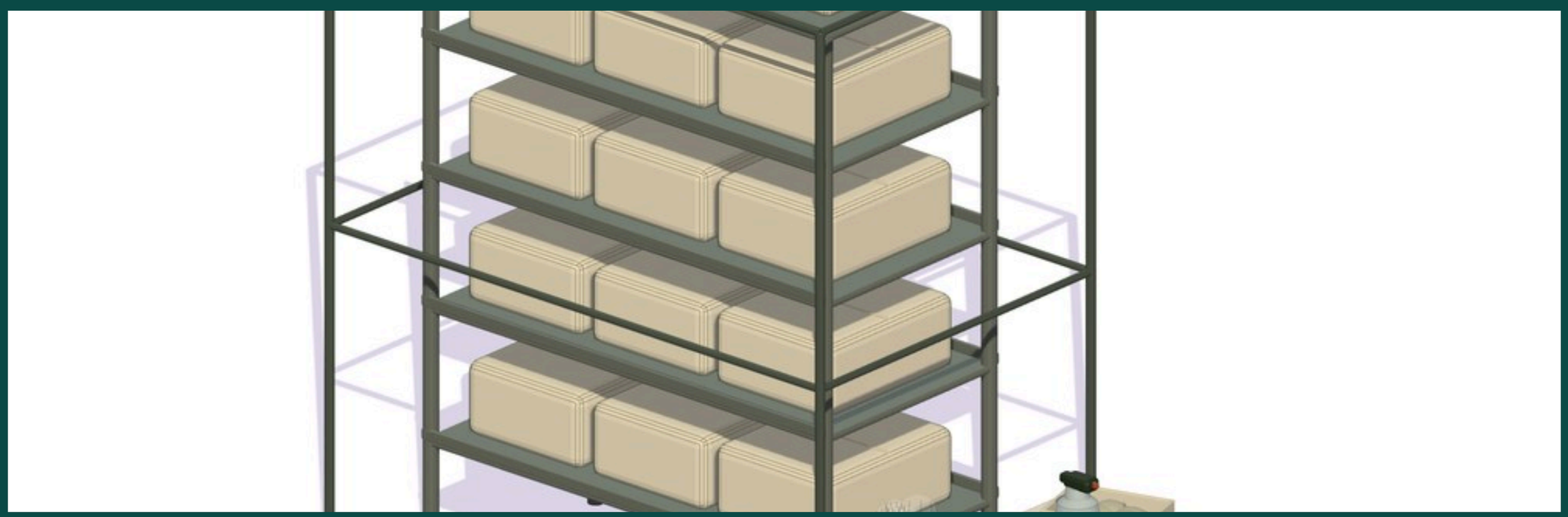
The mushroom process

Seven stages, twenty-two steps. Every weight and every day written out — one stage to a sheet, on the wall where the work happens.

6 KG	6	21 DAYS	63	37 DAYS
A BAG	BAGS A COOK	DARK, 20 °C	FRUITING PLACES	START TO CLEARED



THE MAGIC MIX — EXACT NUMBERS

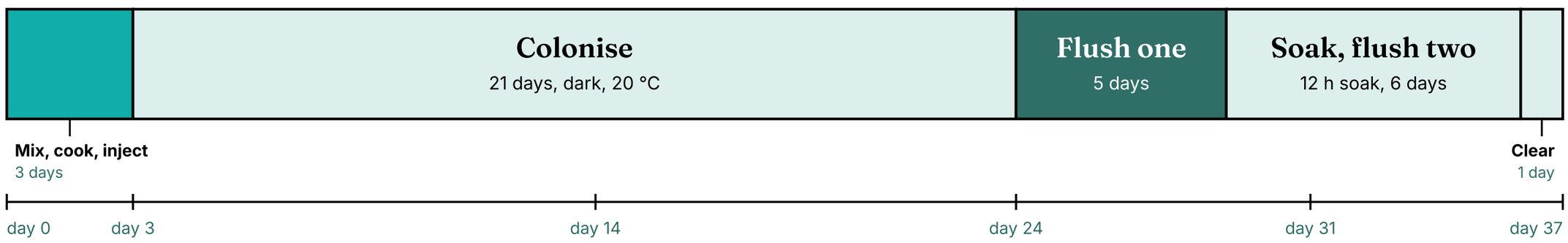
One bag is 6 kg: 2.7 kg dry, 3.3 kg water

Hardwood pellets and soybean hulls with millet. Six bags to a cook, because there is one pressure cooker.

INTO THE BAG	PER 6 KG BAG	PER 6-BAG COOK
Hardwood pellets	**1.2 kg**	**7.2 kg**
Soybean hulls	**1.2 kg**	**7.2 kg**
Millet	**0.3 kg**	**1.8 kg**
Water	**3.3 kg**	**19.8 kg**
Bag, folded and cooked	**6 kg**	**36 kg**

◆ The millet share is one tenth of the dry weight until the room's own ratio is written down. Everything else is the farm's own record or its own calculator.

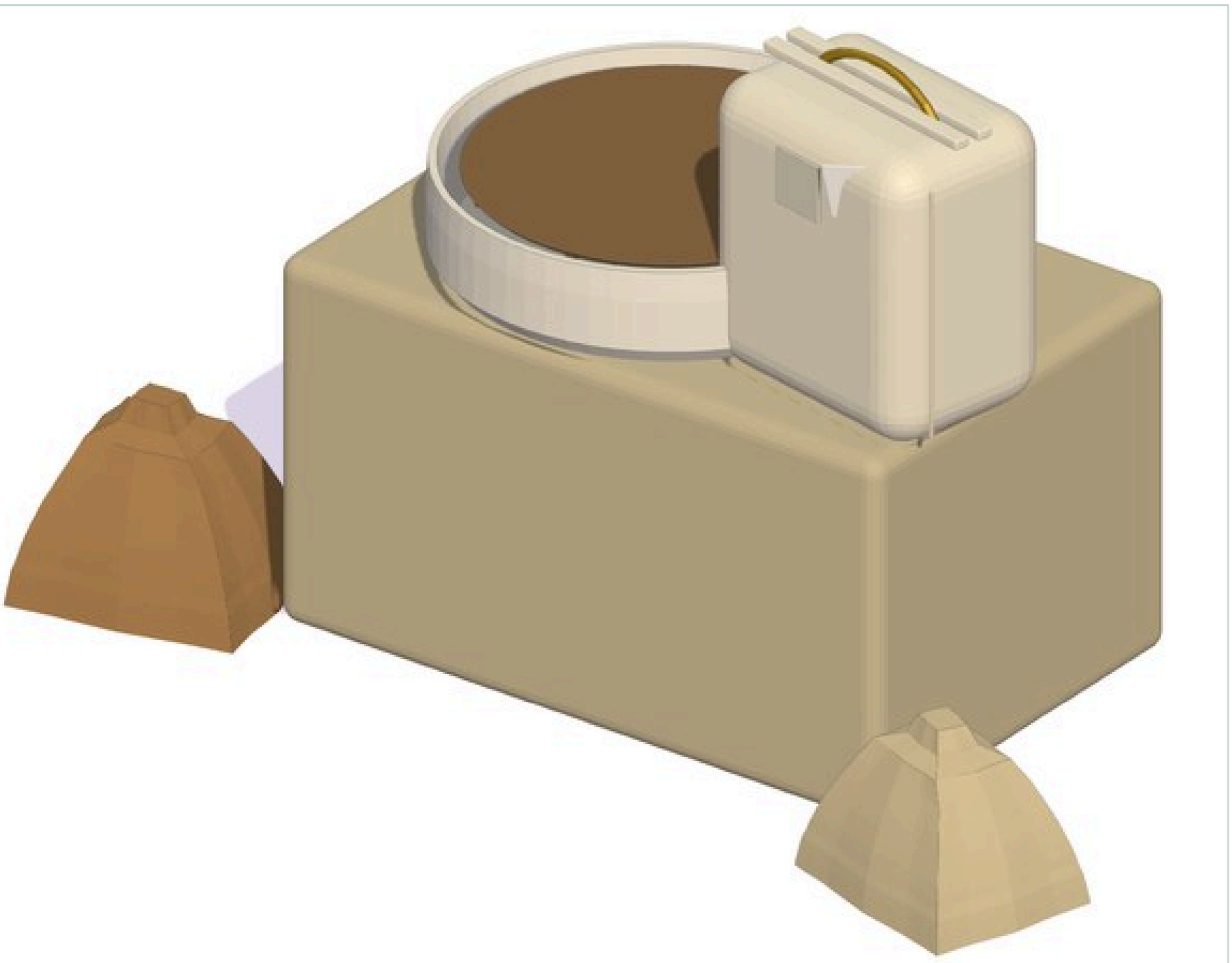
ONE LOAD, 37 DAYS, START TO CLEARED



01

The magic mix

Day 0 · one 6 kg bag at a time



Pellets, hulls, the blended mix, and one bag filled to 2.7 kg.

01 Blend the dry

1.2 kg hardwood pellets, 1.2 kg soybean hulls, 0.3 kg millet. One bag's dry part, 2.7 kg.

Watch · Millet feeds the spawn. Too much and the bag sours before it is white.

02 Fill to weight

2.7 kg of dry mix into the bag, no more. Leave 15 cm of film empty at the top.

Watch · An overfilled bag splits when it takes water.

03 Add the water

Add 3.3 kg of water, then gather the neck, fold it over twice and clip it. Turn the bag over twice so every pocket is wet.

Watch · Clip, never heat-seal. A hot sealer fuses the film and blocks the filter patch.

> 2.7 kg dry, 3.3 kg water. That is a 6 kg bag, and the bag is the measure.

Cook the bag

02

Day 1 · six bags, one cooker



The cooker over the gas ring, and six folded bags waiting their turn.

04 Load six bags

Six bags and one pressure cooker. Load in the morning and cook through the day — there is no second batch.

Watch · Six is the cooker's load, not a target. A seventh and the water never comes back to a simmer.

05 Cook, 2 h 30

Bags in, water over them. Start the clock when it comes back to a simmer: 2 hours 30 minutes.

Watch · Every bag under the water. Hold them down with the rack.

06 Leave it overnight

Then leave it. Do not open the cooker, do not lift the bags. They cool in there overnight and come out the next morning.

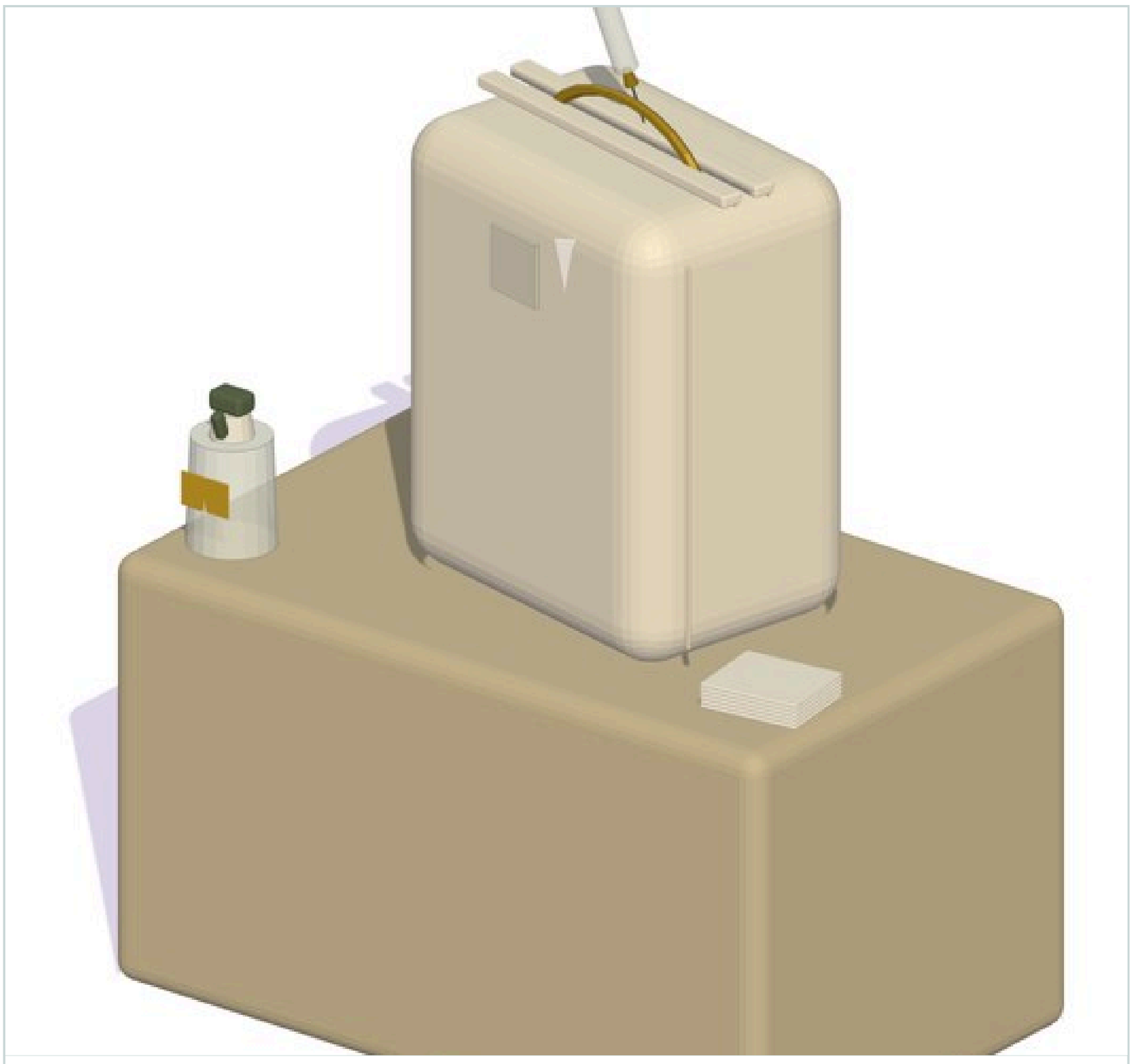
Watch · Eight hours of slow cooling. Opening early fogs the film and invites the wrong things in.

> One cooker, six bags, one day: cook in the day, take them out in the morning.

Inject

03

Day 2 · the lab, one bag at a time



Wiped bench, bag upright, 10 ml of liquid spores going in the port.

07 Wipe everything down

Benches, walls, gloves, hands: 70% alcohol on all of it, then wait 10 minutes. Door shut, no fans, no sweeping.

Watch · One person in the room. Moving air carries spores.

08 Inject the spores

10 ml of liquid oyster spores per 6 kg bag, through the port, flat against the film, then tape the hole.

Watch · Needle into the bag, not into the mix.

09 Seal the port

Tape the injection hole. Then gather the neck, fold it over twice and clip it. No heat sealer.

Watch · Folded and clipped, not fused. The filter patch has to breathe all 21 days.

10 Tag the bag

Date, batch, grower on the tag. Straight to the dark room.

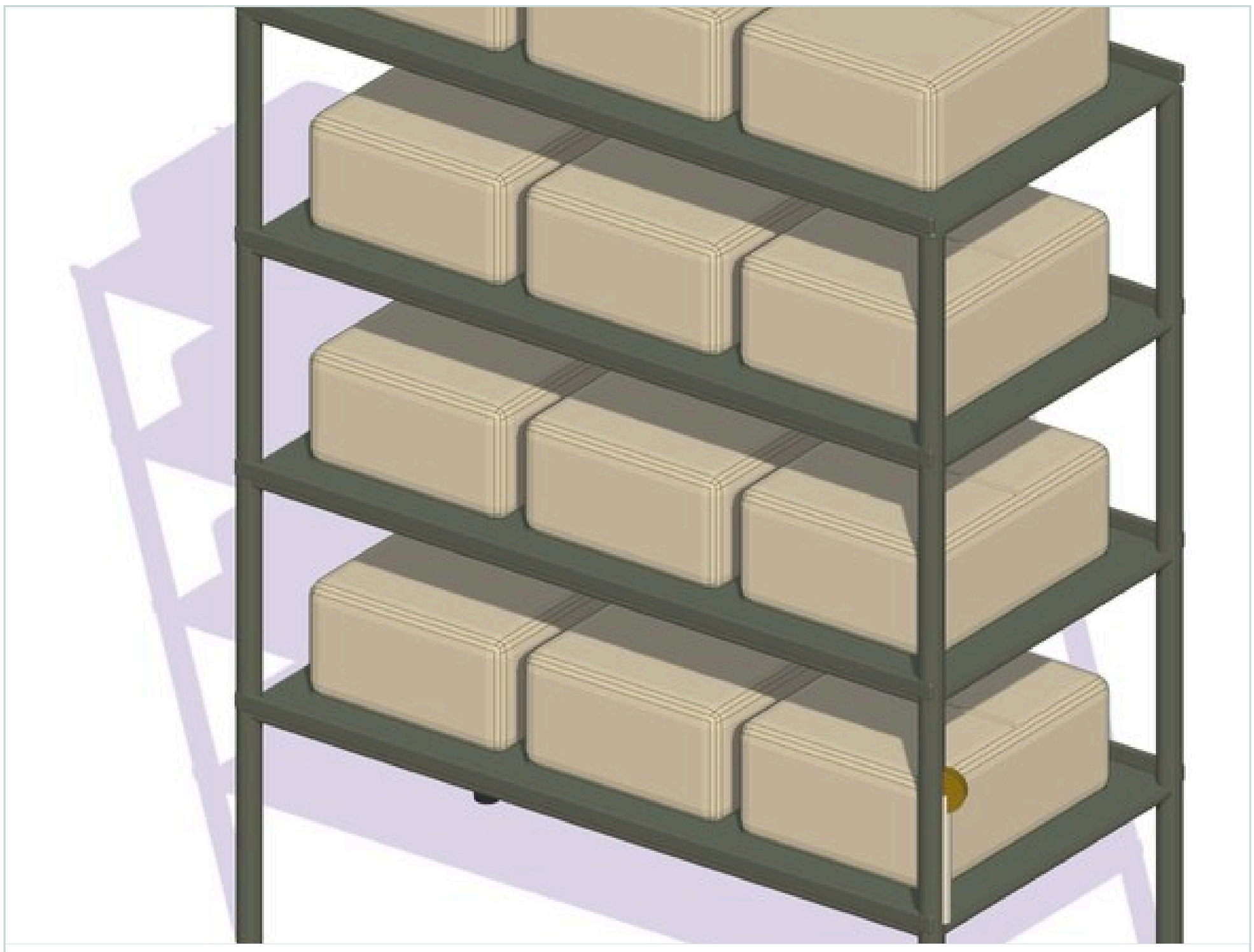
Watch · An untagged bag is anonymous for 21 days.

> The lab is the only step that can lose the whole bag.

Colonise

04

Day 2–23 · 21 days, dark, 20 °C



Bags wrapped tight, stacked two high, filter patch up.

11 Wrap and stack

Wrap each bag tight, filter patch up. Stack two high, never three. Bags may touch. 20 °C, dark, still.

Watch · Three high and the middle bag cooks itself.

12 Day 7 mould check

One week in, look at every bag in daylight. Green, black or pink patches, or a sour smell: out of the room that day, sealed and logged.

Watch · Mould at day 7 never recovers, and it reaches the bags beside it by day 10.

13 Day 21 check

Ready on day 21: white right through, firm to the press, smells of mushroom.

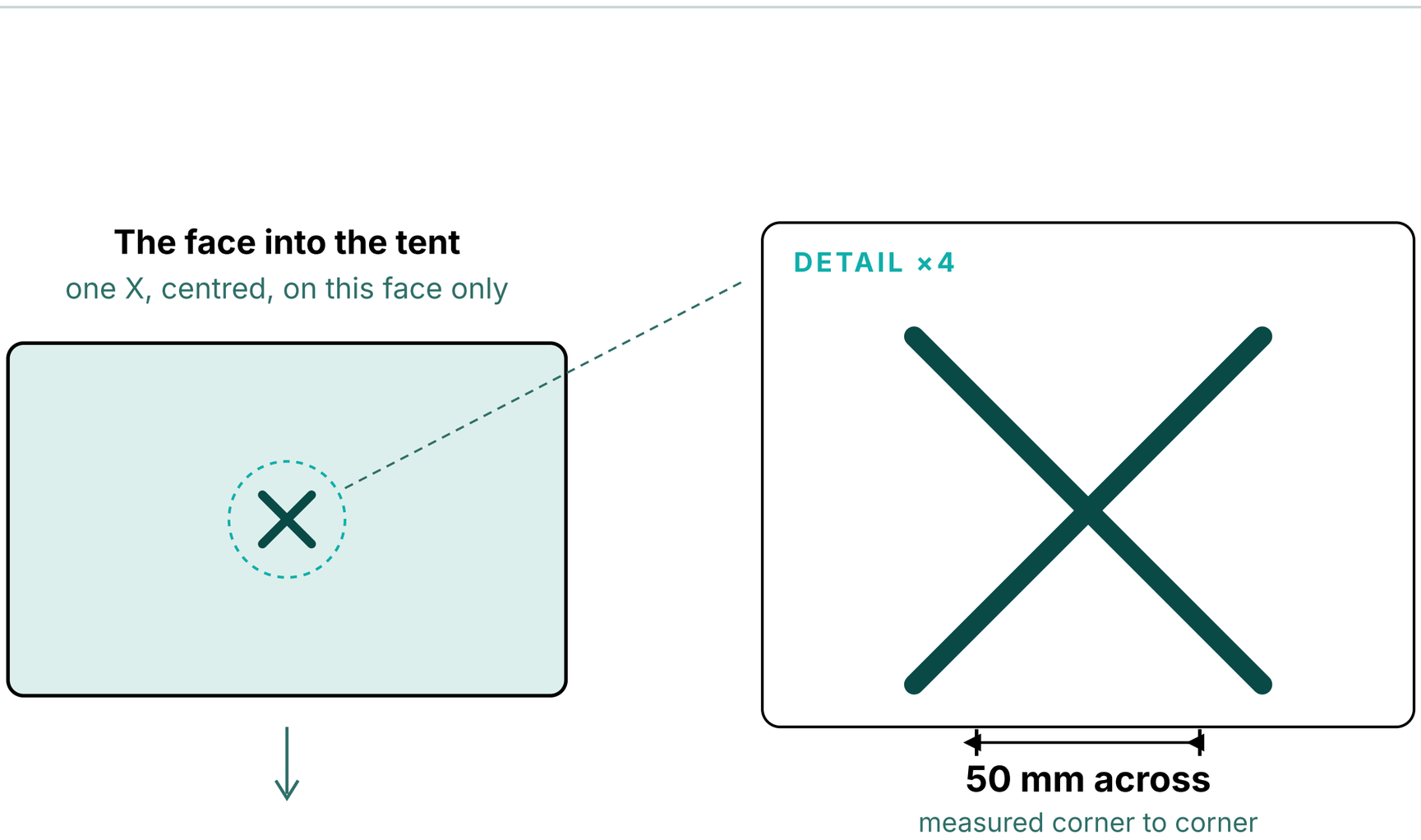
Watch · White on day 14 is not ready. Day 21 is the day.

> Twenty-one days. Not two weeks, not three weeks — 21 days from the tag.

Fruit

05

Day 23 on · three weeks in the tent



One X, centred, 50 mm across. The flush leaves the side and turns up.

14 Cut the X

One X, 50 mm across, centred on the face that looks into the tent. Blade 10 mm deep, through the film only. Then stop.

Watch · Leave it shut. An X pulled open dries out and pins nothing.

15 Into the tent

3 shelves × 7 levels × 3 blocks = 63 places. 35 cm clear above each block. The X faces the aisle.

Watch · The top level runs hottest and driest.

16 Daily check

Five numbers a day: temperature, humidity, fresh air, water, and anything growing that should not.

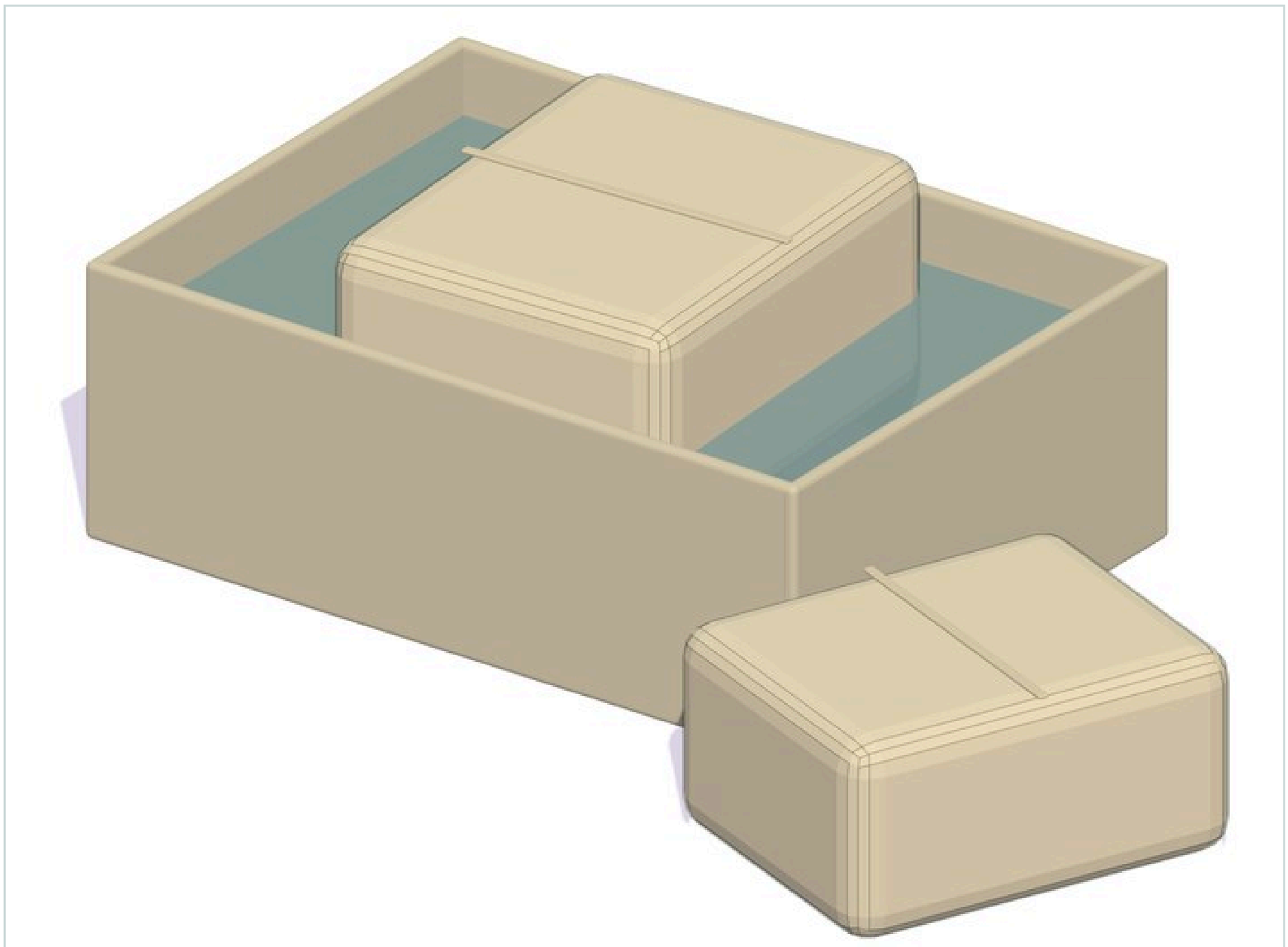
Watch · Oyster wants air before warmth.

> The mushrooms come out of the X on the side and grow upwards. Never off the top.

Two flushes

06

Day 23–35 · cut, soak, cut again



Cold water in the tub, the block under it for twelve hours.

17 Cut flush one

Day 4 to 6 after the X: twist or cut at the base, no stubs. 0.43 kg a block. Straight into the cold.

Watch · A day late halves the shelf life.

18 Soak the block

Cold water in the tub, block under the water for 12 hours, drain 30 minutes, back in the tent.

Watch · The soak is what buys the second flush.

19 Cut flush two

Six days later, same cut. 0.42 kg a block. Then the block is finished.

Watch · No soak, no second flush. Do not skip it.

> 0.43 kg, soak, 0.42 kg. Weigh every block and write it down.

Clear and send

07

Day 37 · out and away



Cut at the base, the punnet on the scale, the knife.

20 Clear the block

Spent block into the crate and out the same day. Wipe the shelf, spray it, log the weight.

Watch · Spent blocks in the room are spores and flies.

21 Pack and dispatch

Into the punnet, batch code on the label, cold, delivered same day.

Watch · Condensation in a sealed punnet turns it slimy by morning.

22 Full clean of the tent

One day, once the last block is out. Empty the tent completely, then work top to bottom.

Watch · A wiped shelf with blocks still on it below is not a clean.

> Out the same day, every day. Nothing spent sleeps in the room.

THE DEEP CLEAN — ONE DAY, ONCE A CYCLE

Tent and racks, stripped and washed

01 **Strip it.** Blocks out, shelves out, floor clear. Nothing left inside the tent.

02 **Wash the racks.** Every shelf and upright washed, then wiped with 70% alcohol. Stand them out to dry in the sun.

03 **Wipe the tent.** Inside walls, roof, floor and door, top to bottom. Alcohol on the film, then the frame and the zips.

04 **The dry run.** Door open, fans off, one full hour to dry. Water left in a corner is where the next mould starts.

05 **Log it.** Date, who cleaned, and what was replaced on the sheet. One day, once a cycle.